

🚩 **CLUB LEAGUE RULES & PROCESSES** 🚩

PLEASE READ CAREFULLY

****I NOW NEED TO MAKE EVERYONE AWARE OF THE CLUB LEAGUE RULES AND PROCESSES.****

****THESE RULES ARE IMPORTANT AND WILL APPLY TO EVERYONE IN THE LEAGUE.****

****PLEASE TAKE THE TIME TO READ THROUGH THEM SO EVERYONE UNDERSTANDS HOW THE LEAGUE WILL WORK.****

Scorecards, Results & Live League Table

- * A ****scorecard must be completed for every match****.
- * Make sure ****you and your opponent have the correct handicaps entered on the scorecard before the match starts****.
- * The scorecard must be ****fully completed and signed by both players****.
- * ****20+ breaks must be recorded in the relevant boxes on the scorecard**** so we can monitor player performances throughout the league.
- * If you make a break that you want to count for the ****Highest Break prize****, it ****must be declared and recorded on the scorecard****. A break cannot be claimed for the Highest Break prize afterwards if it was not declared on the scorecard.
- * Results will be recorded from the completed scorecards and a ****live league table will be maintained throughout the league****.

Why the Scorecard Is Important

The scorecard gives the ****Tournament Directors**** a clear record of every match. It allows us to deal with any queries or disputes, confirm the ****correct handicaps were used****, monitor player performances, keep track of Highest Break claims and ensure the ****live league table is accurate and up to date****.

An ****incomplete or unsigned scorecard****, or a match played from the ****wrong handicap****, may result in the match being ****void****.

We have always used a ****common-sense approach****, but please be aware that the ****Tournament Directors have the right to void a match where they feel it is necessary****.

If you are ****in any doubt about anything****, please ask ****Clive or Andy****. If we are not in the club, ****give us a call****. It is always better to ask before playing the match than to have an issue afterwards.

A Note to All Players — Especially New Players

For any players who are new to the league, **please don't be put off or intimidated by the rules below**. They are not there to make the league complicated or to take away from the enjoyment of playing snooker. They are there to help the league run as smoothly, fairly and consistently as possible.

As the league has evolved, and with it now feeding into the **CrossGuns Player of the Year Award**, the importance of having clear procedures has increased. With **30 players competing for a €1,500 prize pot**, it is essential that we have clear rules and measures in place so that everyone knows what is expected and, more importantly, that every player is treated fairly.

The vast majority of matches will simply be played, the scorecard completed and everyone will get on with enjoying their snooker. These rules are there for the occasions when something does go wrong, so that there is a clear and fair way of dealing with it.

The aim is simple: fair competition, good sportsmanship and an enjoyable league for everyone.

 **MATCH RULES — PLEASE READ** 

1 WORLD SNOOKER RULES APPLY

The official World Snooker / WPBSA Rules of Snooker apply to every match played in the league.

However, because our league is played in a club environment and matches are self-refereed, there are **3 specific CrossGuns League amendments** that will apply to help us manage the league fairly, consistently and smoothly.

These are **league-specific amendments** to help us manage our competition. They do not replace the World Snooker rules generally — **World Snooker rules remain the foundation for every match.**

The three league amendments are:

- 1 Club Miss Rule**
- 2 Pace of Play**
- 3 Player Conduct**

2 CLUB MISS RULE

Club Rule — must be followed in all league matches

A miss may be called up to a maximum of **two (2) times**.

This means a maximum of **3 fouls** can occur, with the **third and final foul** unable to be called a miss.

After the third foul, play must proceed.

The incoming player then has the option to:

A) Play from the position in which the cue ball has come to rest; **or**

B) Ask the opponent to play again from that position.

In the event of a dispute regarding the application of the Club Miss Rule, the **league organiser's decision** is final.

Players are expected to apply this rule fairly and in the spirit of the game.

3 PACE OF PLAY

The official **World Snooker / WPBSA Rules of Snooker** cover time wasting under **Section 4 – The Players, Rule 3: Time Wasting**.

World Snooker – Section 4, Rule 3(a): Time Wasting

> **“In the event of a player taking an abnormal amount of time over a stroke, or the selection of a stroke, the referee shall warn the player that in the event of any further Time Wasting during the game, the frame will be awarded to their opponent.”**

As our matches are self-refereed, the specific referee procedure cannot be applied in exactly the same way. However, the **principle behind the World Snooker rule** will apply to our league.

Players are expected to maintain a **reasonable pace of play** throughout their matches.

Taking additional time over difficult or important shots is perfectly acceptable. However, consistently slow play that unnecessarily prolongs a match is not.

As a guide, a **best-of-three match** taking in excess of three hours will normally be considered unusually long.

This is **not an automatic penalty**, as every match is different and tactical frames can naturally take longer. However, matches of this duration may be reviewed where concerns have been raised.

Monitoring of Matches

While **league organisers and club staff are in the club**, they may observe league matches as part of their normal attendance.

These observations, together with any concerns or reports received, may be taken into account when reviewing the pace of play.

Where, following review, the league organisers determine that **excessive slow play has occurred**, a **2-point league deduction may be applied**.

4 PLAYER CONDUCT

The official **World Snooker / WPBSA Rules regarding player conduct apply** to all league matches.

Players are expected to conduct themselves in a **respectful and sporting manner** at all times.

Friendly banter is part of club snooker, but persistent comments regarding an opponent's **luck, ability, shot selection**, or remarks intended to **distract, provoke or undermine** an opponent are not acceptable.

There is a difference between normal good-natured banter and repeated behaviour that affects an opponent or interferes with the match.

Players are expected to respect their opponent and allow them to play without unnecessary distraction or provocation.

Where, following review, the league organisers determine that **persistent or repeated unsporting conduct has occurred**, a **2-point league deduction may be applied**.

In more serious cases, or where such behaviour continues despite previous warnings or sanctions, the player may be **disqualified from the league**.

In the event of disqualification, **the player's entry fee will not be refunded**.

These measures are intended to protect the integrity of the league and ensure fairness for all participants.

⚠️ **IMPORTANT — SELF-REFEREED MATCHES**

As our league matches are self-refereed, please **do not get into arguments during a match** regarding rules, pace of play or player conduct.

If you have a concern, report it to the **league organisers / Tournament Directors afterwards**, and the matter will be reviewed fairly and consistently.

If you are **in any doubt about anything**, please ask **Clive or Andy**.

If we are not in the club, **give us a call**.

It is always better to ask **before playing the match** than to have an issue afterwards.

🏆 **THE BOTTOM LINE**

The **World Snooker / WPBSA Rules apply to every league match**, with the following **three specific CrossGuns League amendments**:

1️⃣ CLUB MISS RULE

Our agreed Club Miss procedure.

2️⃣ PACE OF PLAY

Ensuring matches are played at a reasonable pace, with measures available where excessive slow play is determined to have occurred.

3️⃣ PLAYER CONDUCT

Ensuring everyone conducts themselves respectfully and in the spirit of the game, with appropriate sanctions available for persistent or serious misconduct.

These measures are **not aimed at any individual player**.

They are being introduced because the league has grown, now feeds into the **CrossGuns Player of the Year Award**, and with **30 players competing for €1,500**, we need clear and consistent procedures in place.

FAIR COMPETITION. GOOD SPORTSMANSHIP. CLEAR RULES. AN ENJOYABLE LEAGUE FOR EVERYONE. 🎱

Thanks everyone for your cooperation and for helping us make the league as competitive, fair and enjoyable as possible.

LEAGUE POINTS & PLAYER OF THE YEAR — IMPORTANT

Just to make sure everyone is clear on how the league points work:

****Every frame won = 1 league point.****

Every point earned throughout ****all of this season's leagues**** will also contribute directly towards the ****CrossGuns Player of the Year Award****.

We currently have ****3 leagues planned for this season****, so every frame won across all three leagues will count towards your overall Player of the Year total.

This means ****every frame matters — not just the overall match result.****

 ****1 FRAME WON = 1 LEAGUE POINT = 1 PLAYER OF THE YEAR POINT****

With ****30 players competing for a €1,500 prize****, every point could make a difference when the Player of the Year is decided.

Good luck everyone, and enjoy the season!  

HIGHEST BREAK PRIZE — IMPORTANT

For the ****Highest Break Prize****, a player's handicap will be added to their break ****once a break of at least 26 has been achieved****.

The minimum break of ****26**** is required before the handicap can be added. This ensures that a minimum of ****6 balls have been legally potted**** for a break to qualify.

Once the 26-point minimum has been reached, the player's handicap is then added to their break total for the purposes of the Highest Break competition.

The reason for applying the handicap is to give ****every player, regardless of their playing level, a genuine opportunity to compete for the Highest Break Prize****.

For example, a player making a ****30 break with a 10-point handicap would have a qualifying Highest Break score of 40****.

This system is designed to reward good break-building while also giving players of different abilities a fair chance to compete.

****Remember: the break must be declared and recorded on the scorecard at the time it is made to qualify for the Highest Break Prize.**** 🎱🏆

🎱 ****FINAL NOTE**** 🎱

That's all the necessary formalities out of the way!

If you think I've missed anything, or there's something you feel should be added or clarified, please give me a shout.

Most importantly, ****enjoy your snooker, enjoy the competition and have a great season****.

Play fair, play well, and ****may the best man win!**** 🏆🎱

Andy

🎱 ****HEADS UP — GROUPS C & D****

Groups C and D have ****7 players****, so there has to be a bye each round. Because of this, some players may have played ****4 matches**** by the handicap review, while others may have played ****3****.

This is simply because there are ****7 players instead of 8**** — everyone will still have played at least 3 matches before the review.

The advantage is that there are ****4 qualifying places from 7 players****, giving everyone a ****57% chance of qualifying****, compared with ****50% in an 8-player group****.

So, while some players may have ****an extra match before the handicap review****, they also have a ****better chance of qualifying**** from a 7-player group.

🎱 ****Handicap review: Monday 31st August.****